

INSEAD

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT THE SCHOOL

"The Business School for the World" is how INSEAD positions itself, and it lives up to the promise with 80+ nationalities on its MBA program, and an equally diverse faculty and alumni network. International diversity has been part of the school's DNA since its inception, over 50 years ago, when it pioneered the one-year MBA. Today the school has the largest MBA program in the world, with more than 1,000 students per year, spread across two intakes (one class starts in January and another in September) and across two campuses (Fontainebleau, a small town 70km from Paris, and in Singapore). MBAs also have the option of taking electives on the school's Abu Dhabi campus, and exchange to top US schools. The school is also proud of providing an international platform for recruitment, with graduates taking up positions in over 50 countries around the world each year.

The program is very much a General Management degree, but has a strong elective offering, enabling students to deepen their knowledge in a wide range of areas. Entrepreneurship is a particularly popular area, with 80% of students taking at least one entrepreneurship elective.

STRENGTHS AND SPECIALIZATIONS

*General Management, Entrepreneurship, Finance, Strategy, Impact
Investing, Energy, Strategy*

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
BusinessWeek	1	25	2	2	*
Financial Times	1	2	3	4	1
Forbes	2	-	2	-	-
The Economist	21	19	22	-	*

CLASS OF 2021 ADMISSIONS (JANUARY INTAKE OF 2020)

Number of Applicants	3000	Avg Age	29
MBA Class Size	310	% International	95%
Avg GMAT	709	% Women	32%
Total Tuition	€89,000		

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASSES OF 2020)

Consulting	48%
Technology, Media & Telecomms	23%
Finance	14%
Corporate Sectors	15%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

McKinsey, BCG, Bain & Co., Amazon, Strategy&, Accenture, Kearney, Shopee, Danaher Corp., Roland Berger, Deloitte, EY-Parthenon, Microsoft, Restaurant Brands International, Samsung GSG, Apple, Google, Uber, Booz Allen Hamilton, Credit Suisse, Doctor Anywhere, Goldman Sachs, Hilti Group, Mastercard, Oliver Wyman

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: US\$104,200

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 89%

*Rankings are relative to other European business schools that appeared in at least three of the four major media rankings. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR INSEAD APPLICATION

BY CAROLINE DIARTE EDWARDS

Former Director of Admissions, Marketing and Financial Aid for the INSEAD MBA program, where she admitted over 7,000 students, Caroline Diarte Edwards has extensive expertise in the business school sector. A leader among admissions industry experts, Caroline is regularly featured in the Financial Times, the Wall Street Journal, and Businessweek, among others. Caroline holds an MBA from INSEAD and is a graduate of the University of Cambridge.



Demonstrate you possess qualities – openness, flexibility, curiosity about other cultures, interpersonal skills, and maturity – that will allow you to fit well in an incredibly diverse environment.

1

SHOWCASE YOUR INTERNATIONAL MINDSET

INSEAD takes great pride in the international diversity of its MBA program: both as regards to the range of nationalities represented, and the international experience of the students. But not everyone at INSEAD has a lot of international experience. Typically, those who gain admission without much experience beyond their own borders are from emerging markets (they may not have had financial means to travel). If you've had limited international experience it will be imperative that you demonstrate that you possess qualities – openness, flexibility, curiosity about other cultures, interpersonal skills, and maturity – that will allow you to fit well in an incredibly diverse environment. You'll also need to demonstrate that joining such an international community will be highly relevant to your future career plans. Someone who has never travelled abroad, and who has no interest in business beyond his or her own national border should think twice before applying.

KNOW THAT YOU MAY BE ASKED TO START ON YOUR 2ND CHOICE CAMPUS

2

The Admissions Committee takes decisions blind of campus choice – i.e. they cannot see whether you have applied to Fontainebleau or Singapore. So the chances are equal. However this does mean that not all campus preferences can be accommodated – typically, a handful of students will be asked to start on the campus that was not their stated preference, to enable the school to achieve the right class size and a similarly diverse class across campuses.

3

YOUR GMAT BREAKDOWN MATTERS MORE THAN YOUR OVERALL SCORE

The average GMAT at INSEAD is 709; the range is typically around 600 to 800. INSEAD advises candidates to target the 75th percentile on both the verbal and the quant; they look more at this breakdown than at the total score. If you get less than 70th percentile on either part of the test, you better have a very strong academic track record, and/or have a profile that the school loves. So INSEAD is perhaps not as flexible as some top schools as regards the GMAT - this is largely because it is a one year program, so the pace is fast, and the school really needs to be sure you have the academic smarts to keep up. And although many love to hate the GMAT, it is actually a fairly good predictor of academic performance on the INSEAD program.

DIFFERENTIATE, DIFFERENTIATE, DIFFERENTIATE

4

There are some profiles that pour in to the INSEAD admissions office by the hundreds: for example, management consultants based in Europe, French Engineers or Indian IT professionals. Whilst INSEAD has no hard and fast quota, they also want to create a diverse class, so in reality, the competition can be tougher for some than for others. If you have a common profile, then you need to be strong across all elements of the application, including your academic profile, your professional track record, your international experience, and your activities and achievements outside of work or study. Try to find some element to your profile that can differentiate you: e.g. a multicultural background, an entrepreneurial side interest, etc.

5

WANT CHANGE CAREERS? SHOW THAT YOU'VE DONE YOUR HOMEWORK

Most INSEAD students are making some significant change in their career. The MBA program measures change across three dimensions: industry, function and country. In fact, typically about 80% make a change on one of these dimensions, and about 25% make a change on all three dimensions. If you are planning a pretty dramatic career change, you could be well advised to join the January intake, so that you can take an internship in July and August (the September entry does not have an internship option).

Having said that, the stats quoted above do not vary much between the January or September entries, so if you are targeting a September start, you can still count on a big change being possible. And while many INSEAD students end up changing their minds about their future plans during the year, be warned that a 10-month program does not give you a lot of time for navel gazing and mulling over infinite options. You need to be ready to make decisions about your future direction fairly quickly, and you also need to be able to juggle an intensive academic schedule with an ongoing and regular investment of time in your job search.

For more insider insights into INSEAD please visit the [Fortuna Blog](#).

DEADLINES & DATES

JANUARY 2022 INTAKE

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	INTERVIEW INVITATIONS	FINAL DECISIONS
Round 1	05 March 2021	09 April 2021	14 May 2021
Round 2	23 April 2021	28 May 2021	02 July 2021
Round 3	18 June 2021	23 July 2021	03 September 2021
Round 4	30 July 2021	27 August 2021	24 September 2021



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, MIT Sloan, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson, and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

